

BRAMBLETREK

A BIRTHDAY OF WONDERS



THE PERFECT BIRTHDAY GIFT

In the heart of Hyhill, the village of Brambletrek hums with excitement. The anniversary of its founding has come again, a birthday not of a single Gnawborn but of the whole community itself.

It is a time when cousins from near and far gather together: the sturdy Bristleborn, prickly in appearance but warm at heart, and the quick-footed Bushborn, ever lively and eager to climb and chatter. Together with the Gnawborn, they fill the warren streets and treetop walkways, bringing with them laughter, stories, and baskets of gifts.

This family of folk celebrates not just another year of safety, but the bonds that tie them together. Bristleborn craftsmen display carved trinkets polished until they gleam, while Bushborn acrobats rehearse daring performances to amaze the children.

Tables groan beneath berry pies, honey-glazed nuts, and spiced cider, scents that mingle with the sound of flutes and fiddles echoing beneath the boughs. The anniversary is more than a festival. It is a shared memory of all they have endured together and a promise of the joys yet to come.

Yet amidst the merriment, one small Gnawborn cannot shake a sense of duty. Bramble, determined to prove himself worthy, has sworn to find the perfect birthday gift. Not just a trinket or treat, but something so meaningful that it will make the whole village pause and remember this day forever.

To do so, he must journey beyond the safety of Brambletrek, guided by whispers of hidden wonders, forgotten glens, and treasures waiting to be discovered beneath leaf and root.

As you join this story, you will not only take part in the celebrations but walk beside Bramble as he sets off to seek a gift worthy of the village's heart. The path may reveal rare flowers, enchanted keepsakes, or perhaps something more unexpected, yet the true measure of the gift may lie in the journey itself.

The first set of prompts in the village can be revisited as often as you like until you are ready to step into the forest with Bramble, seeking the perfect birthday gift for Brambletrek and its gathered family.

THE PERFECT BIRTHDAY GIFT

The anniversary festival begins in Brambletrek, where every street and burrow is alive with joy. Garlands of ivy twine across the trellises, lanterns shaped like acorns glow warmly, and the sound of cousins reuniting carries through the air. It is here, among laughter and music, that your story begins.

FESTIVAL TRADITIONS

The Grand Feast – Long tables are set beneath the roots, where Gnawborn, Bristleborn, and Bushborn share platters of berry pies, seed cakes, roasted chestnuts, and honey cider. To dine here is to remember that no one in Brambletrek is ever truly alone.

Gift Giving – Each family offers small tokens of care: a carved charm, a painted shell, a woven ribbon. These gifts are humble but filled with meaning. It is from this tradition that Bramble takes his vow to seek something greater.

The Lantern Parade – As dusk falls, cousins light acorn lanterns and walk the winding paths around the village, their lights like fireflies guiding the way into tomorrow. Elders tell stories, children sing, and the night hums with belonging.

YOUR PART IN THE FESTIVAL

You begin here in the heart of the celebration. Spend as much time as you like exploring the festival before you set out. You may journal about:

- The cousins you greet and what they bring to the celebration
- The gift you yourself would give if you had nothing more than what lies in your pack
- What Bramble tells you about his dream of finding the perfect gift
- A moment of music, food, or laughter that makes you hesitate to leave

Only when you feel ready, step away from the festivities and follow Bramble into the forest. The path beyond the village is uncertain, but the memory of the celebration will guide your steps.

CARD VALUE	HEARTS	STAT CHANGE
2	A trail of fireflies gathers around you, forming a path that feels like the forest itself guiding your steps.	Morale +1
3	You find a hollow log filled with sweet nuts, enough to lighten your pack and your heart.	Supplies +2
4	A friendly Bushborn troupe shares a song about birthdays long past, lifting your spirits.	Morale +3
5	The Bristleborn gift you a carved acorn charm for luck, its weight reassuring in your paw.	Morale +4
6	A grove of wildflowers is blooming out of season, their nectar-rich petals provide sustenance.	Supplies +3
7	You learn a new foraging trick from a Bristleborn cousin, restoring your confidence.	Health +2, Supplies +2
8	The cousins set up a picnic beneath lantern trees, insisting you rest and share their feast.	Morale +5
9	A hidden clearing reveals a tree heavy with ripe fruit, its bounty more than you can carry.	Supplies +6
10	A Bushborn child presses a ribbon into your paw, saying it will help you “find the perfect gift.”	Morale +4, Supplies +3
JACK	You stumble upon a birthday game in the woods, joining in with cousins who cheer your cleverness.	Morale +7
QUEEN	An elder Bristleborn shares an old recipe and a pouch of rare spices, perfect for a gift.	Supplies +4, Morale +2
KING	You are asked to lead the cousins in a song for the birthday lanterns, filling the night with joy.	Morale +8
ACE	In a glade of moonlight, you discover a rare blossom known as the Gift’s Heart. Its petals are said to bless any offering.	Supplies +5, Morale +5

CARD VALUE	DIAMONDS	STAT CHANGE
2	A Bushborn cousin insists you take a handful of their roasted chestnuts for the road.	Supplies +2
3	A Bristleborn healer gives you a small salve made of herbs, soothing your aches.	Health +2
4	A group of Gnawborn children run up to you, singing a birthday song they wrote themselves. Their joy is infectious.	Health +1, Morale +2
5	The cousins gather around a campfire to share riddles and jokes, laughter warming your body.	Health +3
6	A Bristleborn elder gifts you a sturdy basket, woven to hold your discoveries.	Supplies +3
7	You spend the evening with a Bushborn storyteller, their tales of old kin restoring your energy.	Health +4
8	A family potluck welcomes you, each cousin contributing food until the table overflows.	Supplies +5
9	You are invited to dance in the lantern circle, the music easing weariness from your bones.	Health +6
10	A Gnawborn artisan shares a birthday keepsake carved from heartwood, reminding you of home.	Health +3, Supplies +3
JACK	You are honoured with a seat beside the elders, who bless your journey with words of strength.	Health +7
QUEEN	A Bristleborn matriarch shares her secret pantry, filling your pack with dried fruits and roots.	Supplies +6, Health +2
KING	You lead a toast at the family gathering, your words uniting kin in cheer and giving you renewed vitality.	Health +8
ACE	In a moment of rare stillness, all three kin; Gnawborn, Bristleborn, and Bushborn sing a harmony together, filling you with wholeness.	Health +5, Supplies +5

CARD VALUE	SPADES	STAT CHANGE
2	A sudden downpour drenches your pack, spoiling some food.	Supplies -2
3	You trip over a gnarled root and twist your paw.	Health -3
4	A sharp bramble thicket blocks your path, scratching as you force your way through.	Health -4
5	A rushing stream sweeps away part of your pack before you can recover it.	Supplies -5
6	A biting wind chills you to the bone, sapping your strength.	Health -6
7	A fallen log collapses under your weight, leaving you battered and shaken.	Health -4, Supplies -3
8	A swarm of biting insects descends, leaving you drained and itching.	Health -8
9	The trail grows steep and treacherous, forcing you to abandon supplies to climb safely.	Supplies -9
10	You stumble into a patch of poisonous nettles, burning your skin painfully.	Health -10
JACK	The forest floods unexpectedly, soaking supplies and leaving you exhausted.	Health -4, Supplies -4
QUEEN	A landslide crashes nearby, scattering your belongings as you scramble to safety.	Supplies -5, Health -5
KING	A storm lashes the forest, breaking branches and knocking you from your path.	Health -6, Supplies -6
ACE	You stray into a shadowed hollow where the air turns heavy and stifling. The effort to escape leaves you drained.	Health -7, Supplies -7

CARD VALUE	CLUBS	STAT CHANGE
2	A playful prank from the Bushborn goes wrong, leaving you embarrassed and unsettled.	Morale -2
3	A Bristleborn cousin scolds you for wandering off, dampening your spirits.	Morale -3
4	Disagreements over the best path forward cause quarrels in the group.	Morale -4
5	A Bushborn accidentally spills your provisions while showing off a trick.	Supplies -5
6	You overhear unkind words about your gift-seeking quest, shaking your confidence.	Morale -6
7	Tiredness breeds bickering, and trust frays as small mistakes pile up.	Morale -4, Supplies -3
8	A cousin takes more than their share of the food, leaving the packs lighter.	Supplies -8
9	A heated argument breaks out, leaving everyone quiet and downcast for the rest of the day.	Morale -9
10	You forget a promise to help with chores, causing disappointment among the others.	Morale -10
JACK	A gift you offered is misunderstood, and your effort feels wasted.	Morale -6, Supplies -4
QUEEN	A Bushborn troupe insists you pay a "birthday toll" of food to pass their camp.	Supplies -9
KING	Old rivalries surface among the cousins, and you are caught in the middle of the tension.	Morale -8, Supplies -6
ACE	A deep misunderstanding leaves you feeling like an outsider just when you most need kinship.	Morale -10, Supplies -10

THE WORLD TREE

After days of searching, your journey finally brings you to the base of the World Tree. Its vast roots curl like the arms of a guardian, and its branches rise until they vanish into the heavens. The air here is hushed, filled with a pulse of ancient power. Bramble points upward, eyes shining.

“This is it,” he whispers. “The greatest gift for Brambletrek must be here. Nothing else could be worthy.”

But before you can step closer, shadows stir among the roots. From the undergrowth emerge the Ratkin, lean and ragged, their eyes sharp with hunger and greed. They hiss and chatter amongst themselves, clutching crude blades and broken spears.

“We know you carry something precious,” one sneers. “Hand it over, and perhaps we let you leave in peace.”

You protest that you do not yet have the gift, but the Ratkin do not listen. In their envy they see only prey, and they surge forward to claim what they imagine is already yours.

THE AMBUSH

This encounter uses the Tactic Rules from the Brambletrek core book (*see page 29*). Each player draws 4 Tactic Cards, and the Ratkin act by drawing their own tactic card on each of their turns. The fight lasts until either side retreats or falls.

The Ratkin are a Jack-tier opponent with 10 Health.

Treat them as a single enemy swarm. Their attacks should be flavoured as darting strikes, snapping teeth, and overwhelming numbers.

When you draw their Tactic Cards, narrate them as the desperate, reckless actions of the Ratkin mob.

Fight for one full round. Describe how your Grawnborn resist the ambush, what allies do, and how the cousins defend one another against the sudden attack.

Once you finish the first round of combat, turn the page to continue the story.

THE WORLD TREE - PART TWO

The fight grows frantic. More Ratkin slip from the shadows, clambering over roots and gnashing their teeth. They swarm like a living tide, and for a moment it seems the cousins will be dragged down beneath them.

Then the ground itself shudders. A deep groan rolls through the roots of the World Tree, so low and heavy it rattles the leaves above. The Ratkin pause mid-snarl. You hear it too, not the voice of beast or foe, but the unmistakable sound of someone complaining.

“Oh for root’s sake... can no one keep quiet for even a single century? If it isn’t bickering foxes it is thieving rats.”

The voice grows louder, echoing through hollow bark. The Ratkin twist in confusion, their courage faltering. From a crack high in the trunk, something stirs. With a snap of leaves and the jingle of charms, a figure drops heavily onto the roots below.

He is vast for a squirrel, his tail striped with pale light that ripples like moonlit water. A cloak hangs crooked from one shoulder, stuffed with trinkets and keys that clatter with every movement. His ears twitch irritably as though even the sound of the battle offends him.

“Do you mind?” he snaps at the Ratkin, his tone more weary than angry. “Some of us are trying to sleep.”

A shimmering key spins into being between his paws, glowing faintly with blue light. With a flick of his wrist, an invisible door slams shut across the clearing. Half the Ratkin tumble backward with startled squeals. Another lunges forward only to vanish into a doorway of bark that appears and closes in an instant, leaving the creature gone as though swallowed by the tree itself.

The newcomer yawns wide, as if this were nothing more than a bothersome chore, then mutters, “If you are going to fight, hurry it along. The noise is unbearable.”

Still, his eyes gleam with cunning light, and each time his key spins, another Ratkin staggers back. Whoever this is, his arrival has shifted the balance.

Continue combat with the Ratkin until the skirmish ends. Skaven joins you (Page 10). When it is done, turn to page 12.

ALLY SKAEVEN



Skaeven is an ancient guardian who prefers his rest to meddling in the squabbles of mortals. Unfortunately for him, the racket of the Ratkin has dragged him from his hollow in the World Tree. Though his manner is sharp and weary, there is no mistaking his power.

While he may grumble constantly about the noise, Skaeven has chosen to aid you, if only to restore some peace and quiet. He doesn't exert himself and doesn't reveal his full power if he doesn't have to.

Skaeven can use one of these abilities each day:

SHUT THE DOOR: ONCE PER DAY, SKAEVEN SLAMS AN INVISIBLE DOOR BETWEEN YOU AND YOUR ENEMIES. THIS REDUCES THE DAMAGE OF THE NEXT ATTACK AGAINST YOU OR AN ALLY BY 3.

OPEN THE WAY: ONCE PER DAY, SKAEVEN CREATES A BRIEF HIDDEN DOORWAY. YOU STEP THROUGH IT AND FIND YOURSELF WITH RENEWED STRENGTH. RESTORE 2 HEALTH AND 1 MORALE.

During combat, Skaeven always takes his turn after you and you draw cards as if he is another player and play the tactics you want him to do.

TACTIC TABLE - SKAEVEN

CARD VALUE	DETAILS
2	Door Slam: Skaeven slams a spectral door in the Ratkin's face, dealing 2 damage.
3	Lock and Key: He twists a glowing key, sealing a pathway. The enemy skips their next turn.
4	Vanish Through: Skaeven opens a hidden doorway and pulls you aside. You avoid the next attack.
5	Path Shift: Skaeven warps the ground, causing enemies to stumble. Deal 3 damage.
6	Key Strike: A spinning key becomes a weapon, striking for 4 damage.
7	Redirect: Skaeven diverts the force of an attack. Reduce incoming damage by 3 and deal 2 back.
8	Binding Seal: A door of bark and roots traps the foe. Enemy loses their next action.
9	Restless Yawn: Skaeven's annoyed bellow shakes the field. All allies restore 2 Morale.
10	Crossroads Call: Skaeven splits the enemy's focus. Deal 5 damage but the foe also targets Skaeven next.
JACK	Key Barrage: A flurry of spectral keys spins through the air. Deal 6 damage.
QUEEN	Open the Way: Skaeven opens a shimmering doorway. One ally restores 3 Health and 2 Morale.
KING	Lord of Pathways: Skaeven commands the battlefield. Enemy damage is halved for 2 turns.
ACE	Seal of Silence: Skaeven slams a grand door of light. Enemy loses their next two turns.

THE WORLD TREE - PART THREE

The last of the Ratkin flee into the undergrowth, leaving the roots of the World Tree in peace once more. Skaeven dusts himself off, muttering about the racket, then fixes his keen eyes on Bramble.

“You,” he says, voice quieter now, almost thoughtful. “You’re not like the others. You do not chase after power or treasure. You want to see, to know. I can feel it in the way you look at the branches & the roots. You are curious.”

Bramble fidgets, his whiskers twitching. “I just... I love learning. Every path leads somewhere new, and every place has a secret waiting to be found.”

Skaeven chuckles, a low and knowing sound. “Then you are exactly what I have been searching for. I have grown tired of wandering these paths. My paws ache, and my dreams of Adaphae call me louder each night. But someone must carry the keys, someone who will visit the wonders of new worlds and keep their stories alive.”

From his cloak he draws a great key of shimmering light. It hums softly, heavy with age and promise. He holds it out to Bramble.

“This belongs to you now. With it, you may open the doors of the World Tree. You may step into places no other Gnawborn has seen, and learn the magic that shapes them. Guard nothing. Protect nothing. Simply go, and bring back the tales of what you discover.”

Bramble takes the key with trembling paws, his eyes wide as he feels its weight. He nods quickly, a smile breaking across his face. “I will. I promise.”

Skaeven’s tail flicks in approval. “Good. Then my duty is ended.”

He turns to you, reaching into his cloak once more. From within, he pulls a gift that glows with the living light of the tree. “Take this back to Brambletrek. Let the village celebrate with a gift worthy of their birthday. What form it takes is up to you.”

With that, Skaeven stretches, yawns, and with a twist of his new key Bramble watches as a door opens in the trunk of the World Tree. Beyond lies a soft golden glow.

“Adaphae is waiting for me,” Skaeven murmurs, stepping through the doorway. “Rest at last.”

The door closes behind him, leaving silence. Bramble clutches the key to his chest, looking up at the branches above with shining eyes. “Imagine all the places I can see...” he whispers.

The World Tree stands quiet and eternal, its new keeper at its roots, and in your pack rests the gift that will be remembered in Brambletrek for generations. ***Please Draw a card for the perfect gift.***

CARD VALUE	THE PERFECT GIFT
2	Lanternfruit – A glowing fruit that never dims. It lights the warren forever, a beacon of warmth for all who gather.
3	The Singing Acorn – A small acorn that hums with gentle music when held close, carrying the voices of the forest.
4	Bloomstone – A smooth stone that sprouts flowers wherever it is set down, bringing color to even the darkest places.
5	Ribbon of Paths – A woven thread from the World Tree that points toward safe journeys and guides lost paws home.
6	Cup of Endless Cider – A carved wooden cup that refills each night with sweet berry cider, enough for all at the table.
7	Root of Kinship – A gnarled root that binds to the soil of Brambletrek and strengthens every harvest that follows.
8	Mirrorleaf – A silvered leaf that shows not the holder’s reflection, but their happiest memory, shared with any who look.
9	The First Storybook – A book that writes itself with the tales of those who open it, preserving every new legend of the village.
10	Lantern of Seasons – A lantern whose light changes with the turning of the year, marking festivals and guiding celebrations.
JACK	The Hearthstone – A stone that warms any room where it rests, filling homes with comfort in the coldest nights.
QUEEN	The Crown of Petals – A circlet that blooms anew each spring, worn by whoever leads the anniversary festival.
KING	The Song of Brambletrek – A melody sung by the World Tree itself, teaching the village that their story is eternal.
ACE	Seed of the World Tree – A small seed that holds a spark of the great tree’s magic, to be planted at the heart of Brambletrek, ensuring its bond with the forest forever.

EPILOGUE

The journey back to Brambletrek feels different with the gift tucked safely in your pack. The trees seem less imposing, the paths more welcoming, and the air carries a warmth that is not just from lanterns but from the promise of home. By the time you reach the village, the festival is in full glow. Garlands of ivy still drape the trellises, lanterns swing gently in the night air, and the scent of roasted nuts and berry cakes fills every burrow and hollow.

Gnawborn, Bristleborn, and Bushborn gather in one final circle, their laughter rising like song beneath the canopy. This is the heart of Brambletrek's birthday, not gifts or feasts alone, but the simple joy of being together. When the villagers see you arrive with the present, cheers erupt. Children run ahead to peer at what you have brought, their eyes wide with wonder. Elders smile knowingly, as though they already feel the forest's blessing in the gift's glow.

The present is placed at the center of the gathering. It shines as more than an object. It is a story, a memory, a promise. This year's gift will be remembered not just for what it was, but for the journey it represents.

And then, with a faint creak of wood and the jingling of keys, Skaeven appears. He settles himself on a root at the edge of the feast, half hidden in shadow but impossible to ignore. Someone presses a plate into his paws, and without a word he begins eating cake with quiet, deliberate bites, muttering occasionally about how mortals always use too much sugar. Yet when your eyes meet his, he pauses. For the first time, the weary lines around his eyes soften, and he nods. A small gesture, but one that carries weight. It is thanks, approval, and farewell all at once.

The celebration carries long into the night. Music and dance echo through the roots and branches. Cousins clasp paws and tails, trading stories of what has passed and dreams of what is to come. The forest itself seems to hum with contentment, as though the World Tree approves.

This year's adventure will be remembered in Brambletrek as the tale of a birthday unlike any other, when a gift became a journey, and a journey became a story to last through generations. And as you close your journal, you know that the forest of Hyhill is not just a place you walk through, but a part of you, as enduring and ever changing as the circle of the seasons.